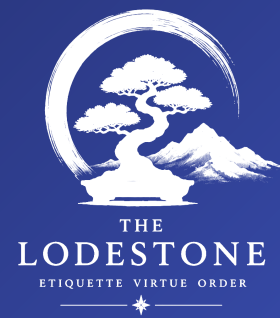


## A PARENT'S GUIDE

# ADHD & Focus

A busy mind isn't a bad mind. Working with your child's attention, not against it.



ADHD is a difference in how the brain manages attention, impulse and activity. It isn't caused by parenting, sugar or screens, and it isn't a lack of intelligence. Children with ADHD are often bright, creative and funny. The challenge is that school rewards exactly what their brain finds hardest, so changing the environment changes everything.

## Signs you might recognise

- ✓ Finds it hard to focus, unless it's something they love
- ✓ Fidgets, moves, or can't sit still for long
- ✓ Acts or blurts first, thinks afterwards
- ✓ Loses things, forgets steps, drifts off mid-task
- ✓ Feels things big, with fast, intense ups and downs
- ✓ Bright in conversation, but 'not trying' at school

## What you can do at home

- **Make the invisible visible.** Visual schedules, checklists and timers do the remembering, so your child's brain doesn't have to.
- **Give one step at a time.** Break tasks down: 'first shoes, then bag.' Long instructions get lost.
- **Let movement help.** Movement breaks, fidget tools and learning after exercise all improve focus. Stillness isn't the goal, learning is.
- **Catch them being good.** Specific praise ('you started straight away') works far better than nagging. Reward effort, not just results.
- **Protect sleep and mornings.** Predictable routines and good sleep steady attention and mood more than almost anything else.

- **Connect before you correct.** A calm, regulated child can listen. Steady the feelings first, then talk about the behaviour.

Your child isn't giving you a hard time, they're having a hard time. Structure is kindness.

## When it's worth seeking support

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Consider reaching out if, over time, you notice:

- › Focus, impulse or big feelings affecting school daily
- › Friendships or self-esteem starting to suffer
- › Homework and mornings becoming constant battles
- › The same struggles showing up at home and at school

### How The Lodestone Centre can help

We work with the ADHD brain using short, active, well-structured sessions, clear routines and lots of encouragement. An optional screening maps strengths and triggers, and we teach regulation so big feelings don't derail learning.

**Programs that often help:** SEL Program, Screening, Progressive Coding, Math Program, Lodestone Evo (early years).

**Free 15-minute call · WhatsApp 012-212 7743 · [thelodestonesolution.com](https://thelodestonesolution.com)**

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This guide is for general information and to support parents. The Lodestone Centre provides educational support, screening and programs; it is not a substitute for formal schooling or a clinical diagnosis. If you have concerns about your child's development, a screening or a chat with our team is a good next step.